

Skill: interpreting

Reproduction begins when **sperm** are ejaculated into the vagina. Once inside the vagina, the sperm move towards the fallopian tube in search of an **egg**. If an egg is encountered, the sperm will surround it, but only one will fuse with the egg and **fertilise** it. Fewer than one hundred sperm make it as far as the ovum or egg.

Once the egg is fertilised, the surface of the egg changes to stop any more sperm getting in. The fertilised egg forms a **zygote** in the fallopian tube and begins its five-day journey to the uterus. Along the way, the zygote divides several times to form new cells.

By the time it reaches the uterus, it has become a clump of up to 80 cells, called the **morula**. In the uterus the cells continue to divide, forming a fluid-filled ball called a **blastocyst**. As the cells in the blastocyst multiply, they start to move around and become different from each other. For the first eight weeks, the developing individual is known as an **embryo**.

After eight weeks the embryo becomes a **foetus**. The foetus is protected by a pool of **amniotic fluid**, surrounded by the **amniotic membrane**. Oxygen and nutrients come from the **placenta** via the **umbilical cord**.

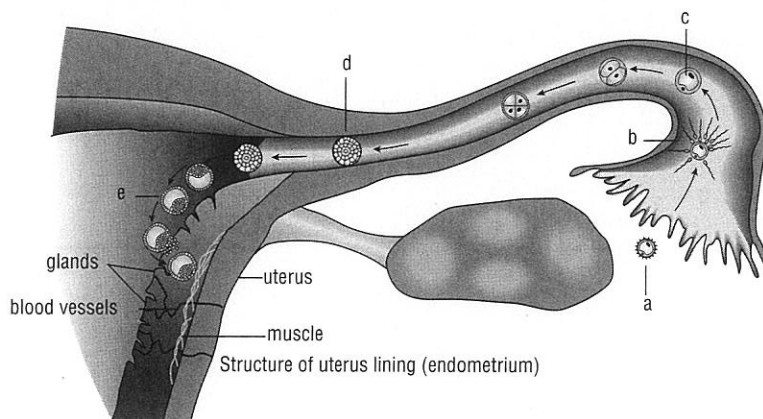


Fig A

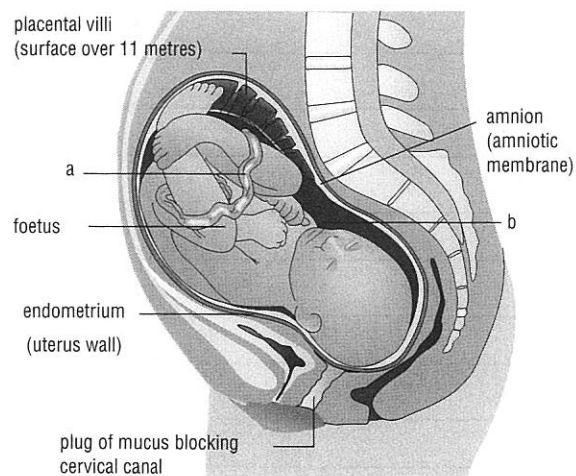


Fig B

Stages of pregnancy—page 2

Name: _____

Questions

- 1 Recall the names of the female and male sex cells.

- 2 Define 'fertilisation'.

- 3 Describe the stage when the fertilised egg is called a morula.

The following questions refer to the diagram in Figure A.

- 4 Identify where fertilisation occurs.

- 5 Identify the structure at c.

- 6 Identify the letter in the diagram that shows a blastocyst.

- 7 Sequence the events from egg to blastocyst by placing the letters in the correct order.

- 8 The zygote is identified as a _____ after eight weeks.

- 9 During the time in the womb, the baby is protected by the _____.

The following questions refer to the diagram in Figure B.

- 10 Identify a and b in the diagram.

- 11 Predict the age of the foetus.
